

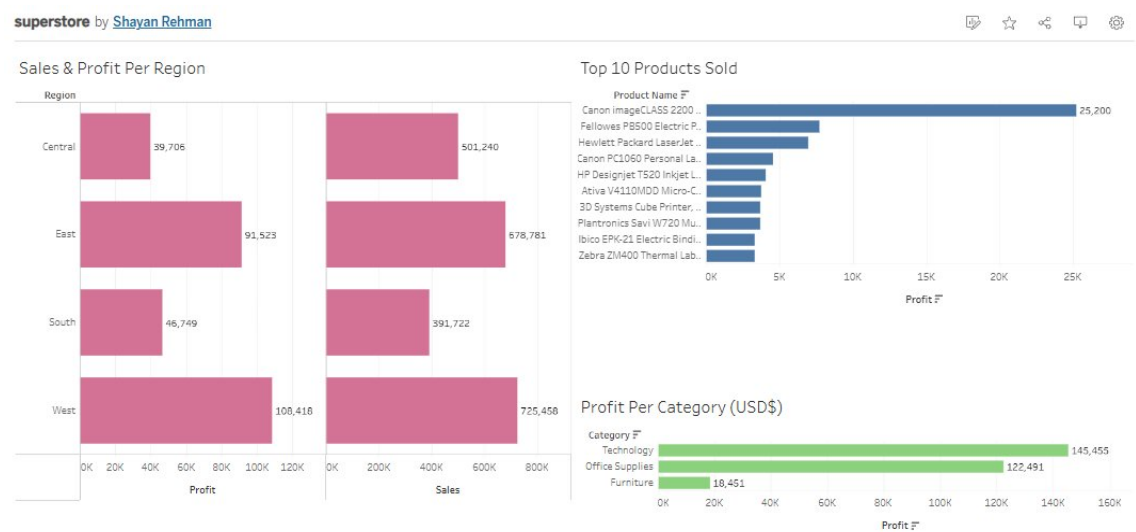
Superstore Sales Analysis

Business Intelligence Report | SQL + Tableau Project | May 2026

Executive Summary

Analysis of the Superstore dataset reveals highly uneven performance across product categories, regions, customer segments, and discount strategies. While overall sales are strong, profitability is heavily influenced by pricing discipline, product mix, and regional execution. The key insight: **high sales do not automatically translate into high profit** — certain operational decisions are significantly eroding margins.

Tableau Dashboard



Key Metrics at a Glance

Region	Profit	Sales
West	\$100,418	\$725,458
East	\$91,523	\$678,781
Central	\$39,706	\$501,240
South	\$46,749	\$391,722

Category	Profit
Technology	\$145,455
Office Supplies	\$122,491
Furniture	\$18,451

Key Findings & Recommendations

1. Product Category & Profitability

Technology is the most profitable category; Furniture is a structural drag. Copiers and Accessories are top profit drivers, while Tables and Bookcases generate frequent losses.

→ Expand Technology product line and upselling.

→ Re-evaluate Furniture pricing; reduce exposure to loss-making SKUs.

2. Discount Strategy & Profit Impact

Discounts above ~20% sharply reduce profitability, often generating negative margins despite higher sales volume. The current strategy is volume-driven, not margin-efficient.

- Cap discounts at 15–20%; replace heavy discounts with bundled offers.
- Introduce approval controls for high-discount transactions.

3. Regional Performance

West and East generate strong sales and profit. Central has high sales but low profitability (likely discount overuse). South underperforms on both dimensions.

- Standardize pricing across regions.
- Audit discount usage in Central; investigate demand/execution issues in South.

4. Customer Segment Analysis

Consumer drives volume but is price-sensitive with unstable margins. Corporate and Home Office are lower-volume but more profitable and stable.

- Strengthen Corporate and Home Office retention.
- Introduce B2B loyalty programs; reduce dependency on discount-driven Consumer growth.

5. Product-Level Loss Concentration

A small number of SKUs — primarily Furniture items — are responsible for repeated losses, correlating with high discounts and high operational costs.

- Review top loss-making SKUs; consider repricing or discontinuation.
- Optimize supply chain costs for low-margin items.

6. Sales Trend & Seasonality

Sales fluctuate monthly with identifiable seasonal peaks. Profit does not always follow sales due to discounting effects during promotional periods.

- Align promotions with high-margin periods.
- Use historical data for demand forecasting; reduce aggressive discounting in peak months.

Strategic Takeaway

The business is growing in sales but not optimizing for profit. Improvements can be achieved not by increasing sales volume alone, but by enforcing **pricing discipline**, improving **product mix**, and executing a more consistent **regional strategy**. Targeted fixes to a small set of loss-making products and discount policies can have an outsized impact on overall profitability.